

Diogo Sá

Game Programmer

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📍 Lisbon, Portugal

Summary

Game programmer with professional Unity experience shipping mobile AR titles from prototype to release in a small multidisciplinary team. Interested in gameplay systems, computer graphics, and developer tooling, with experience building UI, progression systems, enemy AI, shaders and backend-connected gameplay features. Enjoy solving technical problems that improve iteration speed, gameplay readability, and player experience.

EXPERIENCE

Game Programmer, *ONTOP Studios*

03/2023 – 09/2025

Developed and shipped mobile AR games as part of a 4–5 person studio.

- Contributed to the development and release of *New Fantasy*, implementing Unity UI systems, Photon PUN lobby flow, REST API integration with a Node.js/MongoDB backend, and AR Foundation gameplay features alongside the lead programmer.
- Became the sole programmer on subsequent projects, owning the implementation of gameplay systems, AI, progression, UI, and AR features from prototype through release.
- Built designer-facing tools and data-driven systems to support rapid gameplay iteration, including progression, encounters, dialogue, and enemy authoring workflows.
- Collaborated closely with design and art throughout production, delivering features across prototypes, live updates, and shipped iOS releases, and supported technical interviews and onboarding of junior programmers.

FRONT-END DEVELOPER, *BLISS APPLICATIONS*

07/2019 – 05/2021

Summer internship followed by part-time role during MSc.

- Developed and maintained front-end features for client projects.
- Collaborated with design and backend teams to deliver web interfaces.

EDUCATION

MSc in Computer Science, *Instituto Superior Técnico*

09/2019 – 09/2023

Specialization in Artificial Intelligence and Video Games

Coursework completed; thesis not finalized

BSc in Computer Science, *Instituto Superior Técnico*

09/2016 – 07/2019

SKILLS

Programming

C#, C++, Python, Git

Web development

HTML, CSS, JavaScript, Vue.js, Three.js

Backend

Node.js, MongoDB

Game / Graphics

Unity, AR Foundation, OpenGL, HLSL, GLSL, Compute Shaders, WebGL

Languages

Portuguese, English